

Political Change

1889 -> Japan became a constitutional monarchy.

now had a new constitution.

as practiced at that time -> this mean that Japanese emperor -> who was a monarch -> had to rule according to set of laws - even as he retained a lot of power as the head of state.

-> also had to share power with a government made up of different groups -> including the Genro - the democratically elected civilian politicians in the diet and military.

(check if you need the table)

Even though emperor -> now shared power with the government in practice -> Meiji government continued to encourage to encourage loyalty to and reverence for the emperor -> who was characterized as divine and almost god like

-> as such - power of prime minister, cabinet and diet was very limited

nonetheless -> Emperor Meiji and Prime ministers - between 1900 and 1912 - were capable leaders who balanced the interests of different groups within the government.

-> with their leadership and support from the Genro -> there was relative political stability during this period.

-> this would change with the start of the Taisho Period in Japan in 1912.